

**PRE-INTERVIEW**

3-DAY READINESS & COMMITMENT ASSESSMENT

A common evaluation standard for technical, research, design, product, business and operational internship roles

ASSESSMENT WINDOW	WORKING EXPECTATION	SUBMISSION
3 Days	3–5 focused hours/day	One complete evidence-based package

SERIOUSNESS • LEARNING • THINKING • OWNERSHIP • EXECUTION

The purpose is not to prove that you already know everything. The purpose is to show how you approach unfamiliar work, learn, make decisions, attempt meaningful output and document your process.

1. PURPOSE OF THIS ASSESSMENT

This 3-day assessment is the pre-interview analysis stage for shortlisted EduRankAI internship candidates. It is designed to evaluate seriousness, learning behaviour, working discipline and potential before further selection decisions are made.

It is deliberately more accessible than a full internship assignment. Candidates are not expected to arrive as experts. They are expected to make a genuine, structured attempt at work appropriate to the role for which they applied.

THE COMMON STANDARD

Every candidate is assessed on the quality of their approach, evidence, learning, reasoning, ownership and execution relative to their domain — not on whether they can perform a technical task that belongs to someone else's role.

2. EQUAL-GROUND PRINCIPLE ACROSS ALL ROLES

This framework applies equally to technical and non-technical candidates. The domain prompt may differ, but the underlying assessment logic remains consistent.

ALL CANDIDATES ARE EXPECTED TO SHOW	NOT EVERY CANDIDATE IS EXPECTED TO SHOW
Understanding of the assigned problem	Source code or software
Relevant research and exploration	A working app or prototype
A reasoned approach and decision-making	Advanced mathematics or technical architecture
A meaningful practical attempt appropriate to the role	Design files or UI work
Evidence of learning and iteration	A physical prototype or hardware
Honest documentation of limitations and failures	The same deliverable as another domain

3. WHAT A 'PRACTICAL ATTEMPT' MEANS BY DOMAIN

ROLE FAMILY	EXAMPLES OF ACCEPTABLE PRACTICAL OUTPUT
Software / Cloud / QA / Cybersecurity	Code, configuration, test plan, security analysis, architecture, automation, proof of concept, lab findings.
AI / ML / LLM / Data	Notebook, experiment, evaluation, dataset analysis, model comparison, pipeline concept, findings.
Design / UI-UX / 3D / XR / Product Design	User flow, research synthesis, wireframe, concept, prototype, system map, iteration evidence.
Product / Project / Program	Problem framing, PRD, roadmap, prioritisation model, user journey, decision framework, execution plan.

Research / R&D / Aerospace / Frontier Innovation	Research brief, hypothesis, literature synthesis, experiment plan, simulation concept, technical proposal.
Business Development / Marketing / Growth / Customer Success	Market analysis, outreach strategy, campaign concept, funnel analysis, account plan, customer insight.
HR / People / Operations / Support	Process analysis, workflow redesign, policy concept, operational diagnosis, service improvement plan.
Finance / Business Analytics	Financial analysis, scenario model, dashboard, business case, KPI framework, decision memo.
Electrical / Electronics / Hardware	Circuit or system concept, simulation, schematic, component analysis, test methodology, design rationale.

4. 3-DAY ASSESSMENT MODEL

DAY 1 — UNDERSTAND & EXPLORE

DAY 1 QUESTION

Can you understand the assigned problem or opportunity, identify what you need to learn and begin exploring it seriously?

1. Explain the assignment in your own words.
2. Research the relevant context, users, stakeholders, systems or market.
3. Identify important concepts, constraints and unknowns.
4. Study existing approaches, examples or comparable work.
5. Document assumptions and questions.
6. Define an initial direction.

DAY 1 OUTPUT	MINIMUM EVIDENCE
Initial understanding	A concise explanation in your own words.
Exploration	Relevant research, examples, references or observations.
Problem analysis	What matters, for whom, why, constraints and unknowns.
Initial direction	Your first proposed approach and why.
Learning log	What you knew, what you learned, what remains unclear.

DAY 2 — DEVELOP & ATTEMPT

DAY 2 QUESTION

Can you convert exploration into a role-appropriate, practical attempt?

7. Choose a direction.
8. Explain why you selected it.
9. Carry out the most meaningful work appropriate to your domain.
10. Capture evidence of progress.
11. Record alternatives, decisions and problems.
12. Attempt at least one iteration or improvement.

DAY 2 OUTPUT	MINIMUM EVIDENCE
Selected approach	What you chose, why and what alternatives you considered.
Method	A clear explanation of what you did and how.
Practical work	Role-appropriate output, not a compulsory technical build.
Evidence	Relevant files, screenshots, notes, calculations, designs, analyses, experiments or drafts.

Problem log	What did not work and what you learned.
-------------	---

DAY 3 — REFINE & REPORT

DAY 3 QUESTION

Can you improve your work, communicate it clearly and take ownership of its limitations?

13. Review your work against the original problem.
14. Improve at least one meaningful element.
15. Organise the evidence.
16. Document the final outcome honestly.
17. State limitations and next steps.
18. Prepare one complete submission package.

DAY 3 OUTPUT	MINIMUM EVIDENCE
Final outcome	The best role-appropriate result you can produce within the available time.
Improvement record	Initial version → issue identified → change → reason → result.
Reflection	Learning, difficulty, limitations and next steps.
Submission package	Report + supporting files + evidence + declarations.

5. HANDWRITTEN THINKING & WORKING EVIDENCE

Candidates are strongly encouraged — but not required — to use a notebook, blank paper or a whiteboard during the assessment.

WHY THIS IS INCLUDED

We want to see genuine thinking, not only polished final outputs. Rough sketches, mind maps, calculations, decision trees, crossed-out assumptions and working notes can provide valuable evidence of how you approached the task.

ENCOURAGED	NOT REQUIRED
Brainstorming with pen and paper	Handwriting the full final report
Rough diagrams and sketches	Beautiful handwriting
Mind maps and question lists	Decorative notebook pages
Calculations or reasoning	Using the provided worksheet exactly
Photographing selected useful pages	Submitting every handwritten page

Candidates may include selected photographs or scans in the Evidence folder. Handwritten evidence can come from any domain: technical, research, design, product, finance, marketing, HR, operations or business.

WORKING METHOD — YOUR CHOICE

You are free to structure your three days and your working process in the way that best suits your role and problem. You may use a notebook, pen and paper, a whiteboard, digital notes, spreadsheets, sketches, research tools or any other appropriate method. We do not prescribe a fixed worksheet or require a specific format for your working notes.

If handwritten notes, sketches, diagrams or rough working materially contributed to your process, you may include selected photographs or scans as supplementary evidence. This is optional and is intended to show genuine thinking — not to impose another deliverable.

6. FINAL SUBMISSION PACKAGE

The submission should allow the evaluator to understand what you were asked to do, how you approached it, what you produced, what changed and what you learned.

COMPONENT	REQUIREMENT
01. Final Report	Recommended 6–15 pages. Focus on clarity and evidence, not length.
02. Working Files	Only files relevant to your domain: code, notebook, design, spreadsheet, presentation, research material, model, simulation, etc.
03. Evidence Folder	Selected screenshots, notes, drafts, iterations, outputs, photos/scans of handwritten work where useful.
04. README / Review Guide	Explain what the evaluator is looking at and how to review or run the work.
05. AI / External Tool Declaration	State significant tools used, what they were used for and how you verified the output.

7. FINAL REPORT STRUCTURE

19. Candidate details and applied role/domain
20. Task understanding
21. Day 1 — exploration and initial analysis
22. Relevant context / landscape
23. Chosen direction and rationale
24. Day 2 — practical work and methodology
25. Evidence and intermediate findings
26. Problems, failed attempts and changes
27. Day 3 — refinement and final outcome
28. What you learned

- 29. Limitations
- 30. What you would do next
- 31. References and declarations

8. AI & EXTERNAL TOOL POLICY

AI tools and other external tools may be used for learning, research, brainstorming, drafting, debugging, analysis or domain-appropriate assistance. Their use is not automatically negative.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

You remain responsible for understanding the work you submit. Any significant AI or external assistance must be declared honestly.

TOOL / RESOURCE	USED FOR	HOW YOU VERIFIED OR ADAPTED IT

9. HOW SUBMISSIONS WILL BE EVALUATED

Submissions will be reviewed relative to the candidate's domain and level. A non-technical candidate will not be penalised for not producing code; a technical candidate will not receive extra credit merely for producing a large amount of code.

AREA	WEIGHT	WHAT IS BEING ASSESSED
Seriousness & Consistency	20%	Evidence of sustained, genuine work across the three days.
Learning Ability	20%	Ability to research, understand and progress beyond the starting point.
Problem Understanding & Reasoning	20%	Clarity of framing, assumptions, questions and decisions.
Role-Appropriate Practical Attempt	15%	Meaningful execution appropriate to the applied domain.
Documentation & Communication	10%	Ability to make the process and outcome understandable.
Honesty & Ownership	10%	Transparency about assistance, failures, limitations and contribution.
Potential & Role Fit	5%	Evidence of capacity to grow within the EduRankAI working environment.

10. WHAT WE ARE NOT LOOKING FOR

- The longest report.
- The most complex technical solution.
- A mandatory app, prototype or codebase for every role.
- A perfectly polished final presentation.
- Copied work.
- AI-generated work that the candidate cannot explain.
- A claim of success when the work actually failed.
- Perfection within three days.

11. WHAT WE ARE LOOKING FOR

- Seriousness and consistency.
- Curiosity and independent learning.
- Clear thinking.
- Evidence of real work.
- Role-appropriate execution.
- Willingness to iterate.
- Honest documentation.
- Ownership of decisions and limitations.
- Potential to grow.

12. AFTER SUBMISSION

The 3-day submission is the basis for further evaluation. Depending on the quality and relevance of the work, a candidate may be invited to:

- Proceed to the interview stage.
- Explain or defend selected parts of the submission.
- Receive a short follow-up task.
- Be considered for a more suitable adjacent role.
- Proceed toward internship selection.
- Not proceed further at the current stage.

FINAL MESSAGE

This assessment is your first opportunity to show how you work. The goal is not to prove that you are already at the highest level. The goal is to show that you can seriously engage, learn, think, attempt, improve and take ownership of your work.